

Operating the wall from a tablet

A member of staff can now pick any single panel on the video wall, see it live on a tablet at a comfortable size, and touch it — tap, drag, scroll and type — without going near the wall itself.

Internal summary · September 2026

The problem it solves

The wall shows several dashboards at once, several metres wide and mounted out of reach. Until now, doing anything to one of them — signing in, dismissing a message, changing a filter, scrolling to the part that matters — meant going to the machine behind the wall with a keyboard, or opening a remote desktop session. Neither is something to do in front of visitors.

This puts the same control on a tablet on the venue's own network. The operator chooses a panel, it appears on the tablet at tablet size, and touching it reaches the real panel.



The tablet view. The buttons along the top choose which panel to drive. Here the operator has typed “PMP” into the dashboard's own filter box, and the table below has narrowed to the two matching assets.

What an operator can do

- Switch between panels, and see which one they are driving
- Tap, drag and scroll — including spinning a 3D globe or panning a floor plan
- Pinch to zoom in on part of a panel, to read or hit something small
- Type, including accented characters, symbols and other alphabets, which is what signing in to a dashboard usually needs
- Paste from the tablet's own clipboard
- Trade picture quality for responsiveness with a single control

It is not a mirror of the wall.

Only the one panel being watched is sent, captured separately and shrunk before it leaves the machine. The wall's own picture is never touched, and nothing about what visitors see changes while somebody is working on a tablet.

What it costs the wall

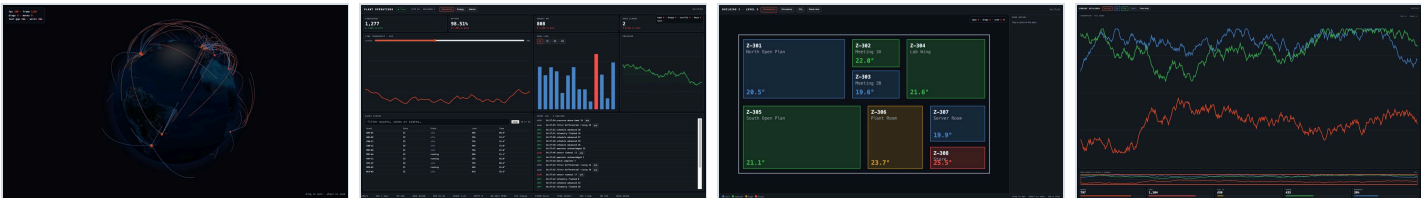
The obvious worry is that watching a panel makes the wall itself stutter, since both are drawing on the same graphics hardware. We measured it against the most demanding content we could build — a 3D globe with animated flight paths, and a dashboard with live charts, a scrolling log and a ticker all moving at once.

PANEL CONTENT	WALL'S OWN SMOOTHNESS	TABLET PICTURE
3D globe	no measurable change	30 frames a second
Building floor plan	no measurable change	30 frames a second
Energy charts	no measurable change	12 frames a second
Busy operations dashboard	no measurable change	10 frames a second

The wall held its full frame rate in every case. The limit is the tablet's own picture, not the wall's. Dense, detailed content sends more data than a large simple image does, so the chart-heavy dashboards look less smooth on the tablet than the globe — smooth enough to work with, not smooth enough to present from.

Tested against content like the real thing

The wall's existing test pages each prove one narrow behaviour and none of them moves or responds. Four demonstration panels were built that behave like the exhibit does, and they are what the figures above were measured against.



The four demonstration panels: a globe that can be spun, an operations dashboard that can be filtered and sorted, a floor plan where tapping a zone opens its detail, and an energy view with a draggable time window.

Where it stands

Working and tested

- Everything described here, covered by automated tests that run on every change
- Recovers on its own if the wall software restarts underneath it
- Costs the wall nothing measurable

Needed before a client sees it

- It has not yet run on the actual tablet that would be used
- It has no password, and typing a login over the venue network would currently be readable in transit
- A decision on what should happen when two people want the wall at once

Recommendation: keep it in-house for now.

As it stands the feature is only reachable from the wall machine itself, which makes it a useful tool for our own staff during installation and commissioning at no risk. Putting it on the venue network is a separate, small piece of work — adding a password and encrypting the connection — and worth doing deliberately rather than as part of this.